

CM0832 - MT5001 Elements of Set Theory

List of Axioms

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Semester 2026-1

Outline

Introduction

Axioms Stating the Existence of Sets

Axioms Determining Properties of Sets

Axioms for Building Sets From Other Sets

References

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Preliminaries

Textbook

Karel Hrbacek and Thomas Jech ([1978] 1999). Introduction to Set Theory.

Convention

The numbers and page numbers assigned to chapters, examples, exercises, figures, quotes, sections and theorems on these slides correspond to the numbers assigned in the textbook.

Classification

- Axioms stating the existence of sets
- Axioms determining properties of sets
- Axioms for building sets from other sets

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Axioms Stating the Existence of Sets

The Axiom of Existence. There exists a set which has no elements.

$$(\exists B)(\forall x)(x \notin B).$$

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Axioms Determining Properties of Sets

The Axiom of Extensionality. If every element of X is an element of Y and every element of Y is an element of X , then $X \doteq Y$.

$$(\forall X)(\forall Y)[(\forall z)(z \in X \leftrightarrow z \in Y) \rightarrow X \doteq Y].$$

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The Axiom Schema of Comprehension. Let $\mathbf{P}(x)$ be a unary property of x . For any set A , there is a set B such that $x \in B$ if and only if $x \in A$ and $\mathbf{P}(x)$.

$$(\forall A)(\exists B)(\forall x)(x \in B \leftrightarrow x \in A \wedge \mathbf{P}(x)).$$

The Axiom of Pair. For any A and B , there is a set C such that $x \in C$ if and only if $x \doteq A$ or $x \doteq B$.

$$(\forall A)(\forall B)(\exists C)(\forall x)(x \in C \leftrightarrow x \doteq A \vee x \doteq B).$$

The Axiom of Union. For any set S , there exists a set U such that $x \in U$ if and only if $x \in A$ for some $A \in S$.

$$(\forall S)(\exists U)(\forall x)[x \in U \leftrightarrow (\exists A)(x \in A \wedge A \in S)].$$

Axioms for Building Sets From Other Sets

The Axiom of Power Set. For any set S , there exists a set P such that $X \in P$ if and only if $X \subseteq S$.

$$(\forall S)(\exists P)(\forall X)[X \in P \leftrightarrow X \subseteq S].$$

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Karel Hrbacek and Thomas Jech [1978] (1999). Introduction to Set Theory. Third Edition, Revised and Expanded. Marcel Dekker (cit. on p. 4).